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# PIEDMONT MEDICAL GROUP

## Threat Intelligence Brief & SOC Action Plan

Prioritized Risk Mitigation for PMG Leadership

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# Executive Summary: UNC5221 Threats

PMG is facing targeted threats from UNC5221—a sophisticated actor exploiting healthcare VPNs.

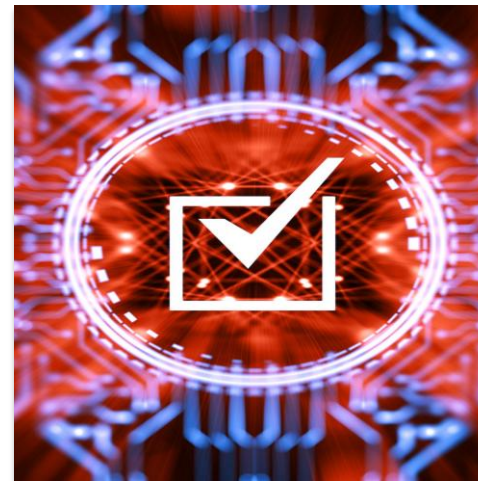
This briefing outlines prioritized actions to reduce risk, ensure compliance, and strengthen SOC capabilities.

## Key Takeaways



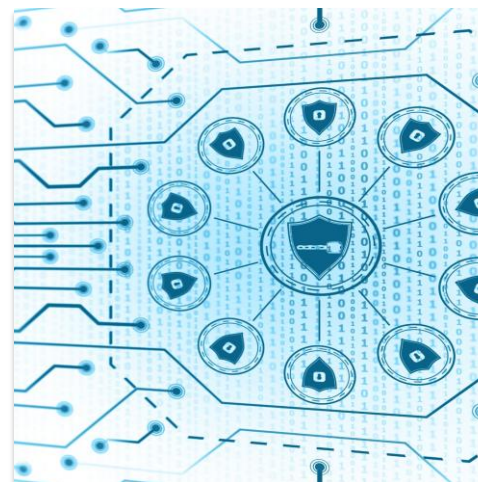
### Healthcare VPNs at Risk

UNC5221 targets healthcare VPNs, creating critical vulnerabilities in remote access systems and threatening sensitive data security.



### Immediate Security Actions

Rapid patching, enhanced compliance, and strengthening SOC capabilities are required to reduce immediate risk of intrusion.



### Strategic Cyber Defense

Long-term investments in cyber defense, regulatory alignment, and staff training are essential to mitigate sophisticated threats.



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# UNC5221 Threat Landscape

## Healthcare Sector Targeting

UNC5221 focuses on cyber-espionage in the healthcare sector, aiming to exploit highly sensitive data and infrastructure.

## VPN Vulnerability Exploitation

The group leverages VPN vulnerabilities, including CVE-2025-22457, to gain unauthorized remote access to networks.

## Advanced Stealth Malware Deployment

UNC5221 deploys sophisticated malware like BRICKSTORM and CHAINLINE, using stealthy tactics to remain undetected.

## Persistent and Remote Access Tactics

Their operations align with MITRE-style techniques, emphasizing persistence and remote control over targeted systems.



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# Top Organizational Risks

## **Remote Access Compromise**

Compromised remote access can expose sensitive data and allow unauthorized entry into organizational systems.

## **Credential Theft and Lateral Movement**

Stolen credentials enable attackers to escalate privileges and move laterally within networks, increasing damage potential.

## **Persistent Malware on Endpoints**

Malware across endpoints raises vulnerabilities, allowing continuous unauthorized access and system exploitation.

## **Limited SOC Automation and Visibility**

Insufficient security operations automation and visibility hinder timely and effective threat detection.



# Compliance & Operational Risks



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## PHI/PII Leakage Risks

Unauthorized access to sensitive health or personal data can lead to HIPAA violations and legal consequences. Protecting confidential information is essential.



## Regulatory and Audit Challenges

Unpatched systems and fragmented telemetry create compliance gaps, increasing the risk of regulatory penalties and audit failures.



## Operational Impact and Reputation

VPN compromise and delayed response can cause downtime and reputation damage after breaches. Immediate attention is required to mitigate harm.



# Key Risk Mitigations

## Patching and Software Hygiene

Validating patching and maintaining software hygiene helps prevent vulnerabilities that can be exploited by attackers.

## Asset Discovery and Attack Surface Reduction

Identifying assets and reducing the attack surface minimizes organizational exposure to potential security threats.

## Access Control Improvements

Enforcing multi-factor authentication and segmenting networks significantly strengthens access control systems.

## Threat Detection Rules

Deploying Sigma or YARA rules enables rapid detection of threats, providing proactive cybersecurity protection.



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# Top Recommended Investments

## **Automated Security Triage**

Security orchestration tools automate threat triage, improving response times and operational efficiency for security teams.

## **Behavioral Threat Detection**

Behavioral detection platforms enable early identification of threats by monitoring unusual activity and patterns in real-time.

## **Data Loss Prevention**

DLP solutions protect sensitive information such as PHI and PII, reducing risk of data breaches and compliance issues.

## **Endpoint Threat Response**

Advanced endpoint solutions rapidly detect and mitigate threats, helping scale detection logic and contain incidents quickly.





# SOC Capability Roadmap

## Current Security Gaps

Manual triage, limited endpoint visibility, and incomplete threat coverage hinder current SOC effectiveness and responsiveness.

## Phased Enhancement Plan:

### Initial Patch Validation

In the first 30 days, prioritize patch validation and deploy advanced threat detection tools to enhance security posture.

### Enhanced Endpoint Security

By 60 days, integrate advanced endpoint protection and crowd-based defense systems to secure all devices.

### Automated Response and DLP

At 90 days, deploy automated SOAR playbooks and begin organization-wide implementation of Data Loss Prevention solutions.



# Strategic Benefits for PMG



## Reduced Incident Response Time

New detection logic decreases response times by 60%, significantly lowering operational risks and improving security posture.

## Enhanced Threat Visibility

Improved visibility enables faster threat identification, allowing for swift mitigation and protection of critical assets.

## Scalable and Audit-Friendly Systems

Systems support compliance and future growth with scalable architecture and robust audit capabilities, ensuring ongoing regulatory adherence.

## Reduced Compliance Exposure

All enhancements collectively minimize compliance risks, ensuring efficient, secure, and future-ready operations for PMG.





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## Call to Action

### Executive Ask:

Approve platform acquisitions and SOC workflow enhancements

### Next Steps:

- Stakeholder review
- Budget alignment
- Pilot deployment kickoff

